he managed to apologize over what had happened to "Grow Old with Me" 2^2 years before. I could now afford to shrug it off. Doubleday had found it more valuable because it had not been pub-

lished and they might not have taken it if it had been. Since I wouldn't trade ten magazine appearances for that book, I now realized that Mer-win had, all unwittingly, done me an enormous favor by rejecting it.

12

On the night of December 31, 1949, as though to cap the pleasant events of the past few days, I had the best New Year's Eve party I had ever had. It was at Rosalind Wylie's. She was Dirk Wylie's wife and had been a Futurian in her own right.

Roz was quite obese at that time (though pleasant, active and un-self-conscious) and had a sister and a mother who were even fatter. She had a younger sister, however, who was thin and attractive, and Roz said she was formed out of the scraps left over from the other women of the family.

There were enormous quantities of food and I ate everything. I felt so hilarious over Pebble in the Sky 3 and the forthcoming robot story collection and The Stars, like Dust— that I had five whiskeys in a daredevil mood, with predictable results. I got high—and I mean stratospheric.

Gertrude, who was as much a teetotaler as I was, also gave in to the temptation, and in the end, Fred Pohl had to drive us home and see that we managed to get safely through the Blugerman door.

It was in this way that 1949 came to an end. It had seen me finish the Elderfield interlude, finish at last with Columbia, leave New York, and go to Boston.

Most of all, it had seen my writing suddenly revive and bound to a new height. I had sold a short story, a serial, and a book. I had had two stories anthologized and I had options on two more books. My total writing earnings for the year 4 came to $1,695, wmcn finally surpassed the previous record year of 1944—and by half again as much.

What's more, my earnings as a chemist, from Elderfield and from the Medical School, came to $4,800, so that my total income for the year 1949 came to just under $6,500. I was satisfied. That was twice the income of my Navy Yard days, and it represented an advance even if